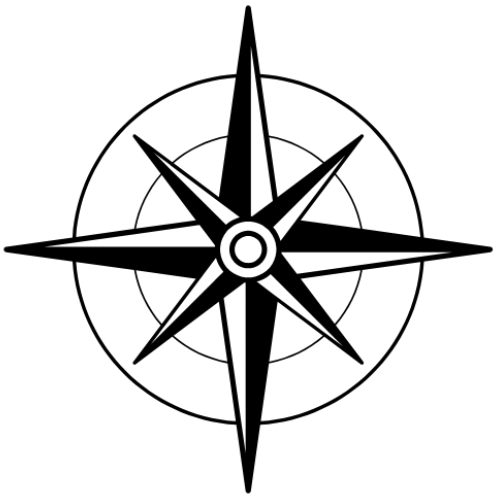
Bonu F&B Platform

Product Ecosystem & Business Model



A comprehensive overview of Bonu's evolved business model:
From traditional packages to customer-driven playground

March 03, 2026
Version 2.0 - Playground Model

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1. Executive Summary

Bonu has evolved from a traditional Vietnamese food business into a modern F&B education and product platform. The new business model embraces the "Marketing Playground" philosophy - giving customers the freedom to choose what they want, when they want it, rather than forcing them into rigid packages.

1.1. Core Philosophy: The Marketing Playground

"Nobody wants to be sold to, but everybody loves to buy."

Traditional education models push students through fixed curricula. The Playground Model invites customers to explore, sample, and choose their own journey. This creates genuine engagement and trust.

1.2. The Three-Tier Strategy

1.2.1. Tier 0: FREE (Trust Building)

Build massive trust without any sales pressure. Give value freely to establish credibility.

1.2.2. Tier 1: TRIAL (The Costco Chicken)

Offer an irresistible taster at £15-20 that delivers exceptional value. This is your "loss leader" that proves quality.

1.2.3. Tier 2: PLAYGROUND (Freedom to Choose)

Let customers build their own curriculum by choosing individual workshops at £20 each. No pressure, total flexibility.

2. The New Business Model

2.1. Tier 0: FREE - Building Trust Without Agenda

2.1.1. Free Offerings

1. Free Workshops
- Completely free, no hidden agenda
- High-quality content delivery
- Zero sales pitch during the workshop
- Focus: Provide genuine value and education

2. Digital Content
- PDF guides on Vietnamese cuisine
- Ebooks on F&B business strategies
- Recipe collections
- Instagram/Facebook educational content
- YouTube cooking tutorials

3. WhatsApp Community
- Exclusive "F&B Community Group"
- Invitation-only (from free workshop attendees)
- Higher quality content than public social media
- Peer support and networking
- Bo's insights and tips shared regularly

2.1.2. The Free Workshop Strategy

What we DO:
- Deliver exceptional educational content
- Answer questions thoroughly
- Build genuine relationships
- Invite people to join WhatsApp community

What we DON'T do:
- NO sales pitches
- NO package offers
- NO pressure tactics
- NO "special deals"

Why this works:
- Creates trust through genuine value
- Removes resistance and skepticism
- Makes attendees WANT more (instead of feeling sold)
- Builds a qualified community of interested prospects

2.1.3. Critical Rule: Never Sell in Free

If something is labeled "free," it must BE free. Selling in a free workshop destroys trust instantly. The Vietnamese F&B community has attended hundreds of workshops - they can smell a sales pitch from miles away.

The Reality:
- People register thinking it's free

- They attend with enthusiasm
- Then comes the sales pitch
- Result: “Never see you again”

Our Approach:
- It’s free, period
- Value delivered completely
- Only soft invitation to join community
- Trust = future business

2.2. Tier 1: TRIAL - The £15-20 Gateway

2.2.1. The Costco Chicken Strategy

Think of Costco's famous rotisserie chicken: $4.99, delicious, probably sold at a loss. People come for the chicken, leave with a cart full of groceries.

Our Version:
- One workshop session: £15-20
- Exceptional quality (worth £50+)
- Highly specialized topic
- Limited attendance for intimacy
- Might operate at break-even or small loss

2.2.2. What Makes It Irresistible

Price Psychology:
- £20 = "Won't even think about it" (cost of a meal)
- £55 = "Let me think about it" (requires consideration)
- Keep it impulse-purchase level

Quality Requirements:
- Must be OUTSTANDING
- Must over-deliver on expectations
- Must leave them thinking "How is this only £20?"
- Must showcase Bo's expertise undeniably

Topics (Examples):
- Authentic Vietnamese pho: secrets of the broth
- Bánh mì mastery: perfecting the baguette
- Vietnamese coffee culture and business
- Spring rolls: traditional techniques
- F&B food cost control fundamentals

2.2.3. The Progression Path

After the trial workshop, attendees receive:

Soft Offer for 1-on-1 Consultation:
- 45-minute private session with Bo
- Discuss their specific F&B goals and challenges
- Assessment of fit for deeper engagement
- No pressure - genuine consultation
- If there's alignment → invitation to Playground

Why This Works:
- They've already experienced Bo's teaching
- They've invested £20 (skin in the game)
- They're qualified and interested
- The 1-on-1 is consultative, not pushy
- Natural progression feels earned, not sold

2.3. Tier 2: PLAYGROUND - £20 Per Workshop

2.3.1. The Freedom Model

Instead of: "Buy my 4-week package for £200"
We offer: "Choose any workshop you want, £20 each"

Key Principles:
- Each workshop is standalone
- Different topics every week
- Customers choose what interests them
- No commitment required
- Natural accumulation over time

2.3.2. How It Works

Weekly Schedule Example:

Week 1: AI for Restaurants
Guest expert teaches practical AI applications for F&B businesses.
Price: £20 | Duration: 90 minutes | Platform: Online

Week 2: Cocktails & Beverages
Bo teaches Vietnamese coffee and creative drink menus.
Price: £20 | Duration: 90 minutes | Platform: Hybrid

Week 3: Food Safety Level 2
Certified instructor covers food hygiene essentials.
Price: £20 | Duration: 90 minutes | Platform: Online

Week 4: Marketing for F&B
Social media and local marketing strategies.
Price: £20 | Duration: 90 minutes | Platform: Online

Week 5: Menu Engineering
Designing profitable menus with psychology.
Price: £20 | Duration: 90 minutes | Platform: Online

2.3.3. Customer Choice Scenarios

Scenario A - The Selective Learner:
Mai only attends "AI for Restaurants" (£20 total)
She got exactly what she needed.

Scenario B - The Regular Student:
John attends 3 workshops over 2 months (£60 total)
He chose topics relevant to his coffee shop.

Scenario C - The Committed Entrepreneur:
Sarah attends 10 workshops over 3 months (£200 total)
She's essentially bought the "full package" but felt in control the whole time.

2.3.4. Why Playground Beats Packages

Traditional Package Problems:
- "I'm not sure I need all 4 sessions"
- "What if I can't make Week 3?"

- “This is too much commitment”
- “I feel pressured to buy”

Playground Advantages:
- “I’ll just try the AI one”
- “Oh, next week’s topic looks good too”
- “I can skip any week I want”
- “I’m in control of my learning”

2.3.5. The Mathematics

Same Revenue, Better Experience:
- Old model: £200 package × 5 students = £1,000
- New model: £20/workshop × 50 attendances = £1,000

But the new model offers:
- Lower barrier to entry
- Less resistance
- More flexibility
- Better word-of-mouth
- Higher perceived value
- Stronger customer relationships

3. Workshop Topic Categories

3.1. Core Vietnamese Cuisine

Phở Mastery
- Traditional bone broth techniques
- Spice balancing
- Noodle selection and preparation
- Serving presentation

Bánh Mì Excellence
- Baguette baking (70% method)
- Pate and fillings preparation
- Pickle techniques
- Assembly and packaging

Spring Rolls & Street Food
- Fresh vs fried techniques
- Wrapper selection
- Filling combinations
- Dipping sauces

Vietnamese Coffee Culture
- Traditional drip method
- Egg coffee preparation
- Menu innovation
- Coffee business models

3.2. F&B Business Skills

Food Cost Control
- Recipe costing
- Portion control
- Waste reduction
- Profit margin optimization

Menu Engineering
- Psychology of menu design
- Pricing strategies
- Star/plow horse/puzzle/dog analysis
- Seasonal menu planning

Marketing for Restaurants
- Social media content creation
- Local SEO
- Customer retention
- Referral programs

Kitchen Operations
- Workflow optimization
- Prep systems
- Staff training
- Quality consistency

3.3. Technology & Innovation

AI in F&B

- Inventory management
- Recipe development
- Customer service chatbots
- Marketing automation

Online Ordering Systems

- Platform selection
- Menu optimization for delivery
- Packaging strategies
- Customer data utilization

3.4. Compliance & Safety

Food Safety Level 2

- HACCP principles
- Temperature control
- Allergen management
- Hygiene standards

UK F&B Regulations

- Licensing requirements
- Health inspections
- Insurance needs
- Employment law basics

4. Product Catalog (Physical Products)

4.1. Featured Products

4.1.1. Bánh Mì Sài Gòn (Saigon Baguette)

Price: £9 per loaf | **Promotion**: Buy 10 get 1 free

The flagship product of Bonu. Traditional Saigon baguettes pre-baked to 70%, allowing customers to finish baking at home for maximum freshness and crispy texture.

Key Features:
- 70% pre-baked for optimal freshness
- All fillings separately packed in glass containers
- Includes: pork liver pate, cold cuts, pork floss, pickled vegetables, Vietnamese ham, butter sauce
- Complete preparation instructions included
- Suitable for freezing

Packaging: Premium glass containers ensure hygiene and quality preservation.

4.1.2. Bò Viên (Beef Balls)

Price: £15 per 500g

Homemade beef balls crafted entirely in-house following traditional procedures. No preservatives, making them ideal for families with children.

Key Features:
- 100% fresh beef
- Bouncy, authentic texture
- No preservatives or artificial ingredients
- Versatile - perfect for pho, hu tieu, or hot pot
- Family-friendly

4.2. Product-Workshop Synergy

The workshop ecosystem and physical products complement each other:

Products Drive Workshop Interest:
- Customers who love bánh mì → attend Bánh Mì Mastery workshop
- Learn to make their own
- Become brand ambassadors

Workshops Drive Product Sales:
- Workshop attendees try samples
- Experience quality firsthand
- Order products for home use
- Understand the craftsmanship

5. Customer Journey Mapping

5.1. Journey A: Workshop-First Customer

Stage 1: Discovery
Sees free workshop announcement on Instagram → Registers with curiosity

Stage 2: Free Workshop
Attends, learns valuable content, impressed by Bo's expertise
Joins WhatsApp Community (no sales pressure = positive experience)

Stage 3: Community Engagement
Receives valuable tips in WhatsApp group
Sees announcements for £20 specialized workshops

Stage 4: Trial Purchase
Decides to try "Phở Mastery" for £20
Blown away by depth and quality

Stage 5: Regular Attendee
Attends 1-2 workshops per month based on interest
Feels in control, no pressure

Stage 6: Product Customer
Orders bánh mì products after learning the technique
Appreciates the difficulty and quality

Stage 7: Brand Advocate
Recommends workshops to F&B friends
Shares products on social media

Lifetime Value: £200-500 (workshops + products + referrals)

5.2. Journey B: Product-First Customer

Stage 1: Discovery
Finds Bonu products at a market or via Instagram

Stage 2: First Purchase
Orders bánh mì, impressed by quality and packaging

Stage 3: Curiosity
Wonders how it's made, sees workshop info on packaging

Stage 4: Free Workshop
Attends free workshop to learn more about Vietnamese cuisine

Stage 5: WhatsApp Community
Joins community, engages with content

Stage 6: Specialized Learning
Attends £20 workshops on topics of interest

Stage 7: Repeat Customer
Regular product orders + occasional workshop attendance

Lifetime Value: £500-1,000 (products + workshops)

6. Platform Architecture

6.1. Technology Stack

6.1.1. Frontend Layer

- **Framework**: Next.js 14.2.3 with App Router
- **Language**: TypeScript for type safety
- **Styling**: Tailwind CSS with custom Bonu brand colors
  - Cream: `#FDF8F3`
  - Terracotta: `#C4704A`
  - Espresso: `#3D2314`
  - Gold: `#D4A853`
- **UI Components**: shadcn/ui component library
- **State Management**: Zustand (cart management)

6.1.2. Backend Infrastructure

- **Database**: Self-hosted PostgreSQL with Prisma ORM
- **Authentication**: NextAuth.js with Prisma adapter
- **Storage**: Cloudflare R2 (S3-compatible) for images and workshop materials
- **Email**: Resend for transactional and marketing emails
- **Payments**: Stripe integration for workshop bookings and products

6.1.3. Deployment

- **Hosting**: DigitalOcean VPS (self-hosted)
- **Web Server**: Nginx with SSL (Let's Encrypt)
- **Containerization**: Docker Compose
- **CI/CD**: GitHub Actions for automated deployments

6.2. New Features for Playground Model

6.2.1. Workshop Booking System

Individual Workshop Registration:

- Browse available workshops by topic/date
- One-click registration at £20
- Stripe payment integration
- Automatic confirmation email
- Calendar invite (Google Calendar sync)

Workshop Administration:

- Create workshops with topic, date, capacity
- Manage registrations and attendance
- Send reminders (24h and 1h before)
- Share materials and recordings
- Collect feedback

6.2.2. WhatsApp Community Integration

Automated Invitation System:

- After free workshop attendance
- Generates unique invitation link
- Tracks community growth

- Segments by interests

Content Management:
- Schedule posts to community
- Share workshop announcements
- Poll members for topic interests
- Share quick tips and recipes

6.2.3. Analytics Dashboard

Workshop Metrics:
- Registration conversion rates
- Attendance rates
- Revenue per workshop topic
- Popular topics identification
- Customer acquisition cost

Customer Insights:
- Journey tracking (free → trial → playground)
- Lifetime value calculations
- Cohort analysis
- Churn prediction

7. Revenue Model & Projections

7.1. Revenue Streams

1. Workshop Revenue
Free workshops: £0 (marketing investment)
Trial workshops: £15-20 × attendees
Playground workshops: £20 × attendees

2. Product Sales
Bánh mì: £9/loaf (buy 10 get 1 free)
Beef balls: £15/500g
Other products: Variable

3. Private Consultations
1-on-1 sessions: £50-100 per 45 minutes
Business coaching packages: £500+ (future)

7.2. Monthly Projections (Conservative)

7.2.1. Month 1-3: Building Foundation

Free Workshops:
- 2 per month × 20 attendees = 40 people
- WhatsApp community: 40 members
- Revenue: £0 (investment phase)

Trial Workshops:
- 2 per month × 10 attendees × £20 = £400/month

Playground Workshops:
- 4 per month × 8 attendees × £20 = £640/month

Product Sales:
- 50 loaves bánh mì × £9 = £450/month
- Other products: £200/month

Total Monthly Revenue: £1,700

7.2.2. Month 4-6: Growth Phase

Free Workshops:
- 2 per month × 30 attendees = 60 people
- WhatsApp community: 150+ members

Trial + Playground:
- 6-8 workshops/month × 12 avg attendees × £20 = £1,440-1,920/month

Product Sales:
- 100 loaves + other products = £1,200/month

Total Monthly Revenue: £3,000-3,500

7.2.3. Month 7-12: Established Phase

Workshops:
- 10-12 workshops/month × 15 avg attendees × £20 = £3,000-3,600/month

Product Sales:

- 150+ loaves + expanding product line = £2,000+/month

Private Consultations:
- 4-6 sessions/month × £75 avg = £300-450/month

Total Monthly Revenue: £5,500-6,500/month

7.3. Cost Structure

Fixed Costs:
- VPS hosting: £20/month
- Email service (Resend): £20/month
- Stripe fees: 2.9% + 30p per transaction
- Domain & SSL: £1/month (annual)
- Workshop platform (Zoom): £15/month

Variable Costs:
- Ingredients for product orders: 40% of product revenue
- Guest expert fees: £50-100 per workshop (optional)
- Marketing: £100-200/month

Total Monthly Costs: £500-800 (excluding product costs)

Net Monthly Profit (Month 7-12): £3,000-4,000

8. Implementation Roadmap

8.1. Phase 1: Foundation (Weeks 1-4)

Website Updates:
- [ ] Create workshop landing pages
- [ ] Implement Stripe payment for workshops
- [ ] Build workshop registration system
- [ ] Add WhatsApp community invitation flow

Content Creation:
- [ ] Plan 3 free workshop topics
- [ ] Develop 5 trial workshop curricula
- [ ] Create 10 playground workshop outlines
- [ ] Design marketing materials

Community Setup:
- [ ] Create WhatsApp Business account
- [ ] Set up community guidelines
- [ ] Plan content calendar for group

8.2. Phase 2: Launch (Weeks 5-8)

Free Workshop Series:
- Week 1: "Vietnamese Street Food Secrets"
- Week 3: "Starting Your F&B Business in UK"
- Week 5: "Authentic Phở at Home"
- Week 7: "Coffee Culture & Business"

Trial Workshops:
- Offer 1-2 specialized workshops
- Collect feedback intensively
- Refine delivery format

Metrics to Track:
- Free workshop attendance rate
- WhatsApp group join rate
- Trial workshop conversion (free → paid)
- Customer feedback scores

8.3. Phase 3: Playground Launch (Weeks 9-12)

Workshop Calendar:
- Publish 4-week rolling calendar
- Offer diverse topics
- Test different time slots
- A/B test descriptions and pricing

Optimization:
- Analyze which topics perform best
- Adjust based on attendance
- Survey community for wanted topics
- Refine marketing messages

8.4. Phase 4: Scale (Month 4+)

Expansion Areas:

- Add more workshop topics
- Invite guest experts
- Create workshop recordings (premium content)
- Develop certification programs
- Launch product subscriptions
- Build recipe membership site

9. Marketing Strategy

9.1. Content Marketing

9.1.1. Instagram Strategy

- Daily stories: behind-the-scenes cooking
- 3-4 feed posts/week: recipes, tips, culture
- Reels: quick cooking techniques (trending)
- Workshop announcements with clear CTA

9.1.2. Facebook Approach

- Join UK Vietnamese food groups
- Share valuable content (not spammy)
- Engage with F&B business groups
- Host live cooking sessions
- Event pages for free workshops

9.1.3. WhatsApp Community

- Daily good morning with quick tip
- 2-3 substantial posts per week
- Member spotlights and success stories
- Polls for workshop topic ideas
- Exclusive offers for community

9.2. Workshop Promotion

9.2.1. Free Workshop Marketing

Goal: Maximum attendance, build community

- Facebook events (invite friends)
- Instagram carousel posts (value preview)
- Email to existing customers
- Partner with Vietnamese community groups
- Cross-promote with complementary businesses

9.2.2. Paid Workshop Marketing

Goal: Qualified attendees who will engage

- Target WhatsApp community first
- Email sequence to past attendees
- Instagram ads to local F&B audience
- Testimonials from previous workshops
- Limited spots create urgency (genuine)

9.3. Email Marketing

Segmentation:

- Free workshop attendees (nurture sequence)
- Trial workshop graduates (playground invites)
- Product customers (workshop awareness)
- Playground regulars (new topic alerts)

Automation:
- Welcome sequence for new community members
- Workshop reminder sequence (7 days, 1 day, 2 hours before)
- Post-workshop follow-up and feedback request
- Inactive customer re-engagement

10. Success Metrics & KPIs

10.1. Workshop Performance

Attendance Metrics:
- Registration rate (views → signups)
- Attendance rate (signups → actual attendance)
- Feedback scores (1-10 scale)
- Net Promoter Score (NPS)

Conversion Metrics:
- Free → WhatsApp community: Target 80%+
- Free → Trial workshop: Target 20%+
- Trial → 1-on-1 consultation: Target 30%+
- 1-on-1 → Playground regular: Target 50%+

Engagement Metrics:
- WhatsApp community active members
- Average workshops attended per customer
- Repeat attendance rate
- Referral rate

10.2. Business Health

Revenue Metrics:
- Monthly recurring revenue (workshops)
- Product sales growth
- Customer lifetime value
- Customer acquisition cost

Operational Metrics:
- Workshop profitability per topic
- Time spent on workshop prep vs delivery
- Platform uptime and performance
- Payment processing success rate

Community Metrics:
- WhatsApp community growth rate
- Community engagement rate
- Member satisfaction
- Organic reach and shares

10.3. Targets (Month 12)

- WhatsApp Community: 500+ active members
- Monthly Workshop Revenue: £3,000+
- Monthly Product Revenue: £2,000+
- Average Customer LTV: £250+
- Workshop NPS: 70+
- Product Repeat Purchase Rate: 40%+

11. Why This Model Works

11.1. Psychological Principles

11.1.1. Autonomy

People resist being told what to do but love making their own choices. The Playground model gives complete autonomy while still guiding the journey.

11.1.2. Reciprocity

The free workshop creates genuine goodwill. No sales pitch means the value is pure gift, triggering natural reciprocity.

11.1.3. Loss Aversion

At £20 per workshop, the "loss" of skipping an interesting topic hurts more than the cost. This drives attendance without pressure.

11.1.4. Social Proof

As the WhatsApp community grows, FOMO (fear of missing out) naturally attracts more members. Testimonials become powerful.

11.1.5. Commitment & Consistency

Small commitments (free workshop) lead to larger ones (trial) which lead to regular engagement (playground). Each step feels natural.

11.2. Competitive Advantages

vs Traditional Cooking Classes:

- More flexible scheduling
- Lower price point
- Business-focused content
- Online + offline options
- Community aspect

vs Online Courses:

- Live interaction with expert
- Networking opportunities
- Immediate Q&A
- Cultural authenticity
- Practical, actionable content

vs Consulting Services:

- Lower barrier to entry
- Learn before committing to consulting
- Peer learning benefits
- Ongoing relationship vs one-time engagement

11.3. Risk Mitigation

What if people only attend free workshops?

That's okay. They're building brand awareness and may buy products or refer others.

What if £20 workshops don't fill?

Lower prices to £15 or bundle topics. The flexibility allows rapid adjustment.

What if customers never commit to packages?
They don't need to. 10 workshops at £20 = £200 organically.

What if competition copies the model?
Execution, expertise, and community are hard to replicate. Bo's authenticity is the moat.

12. Future Vision

12.1. Year 1: Establish the Playground

- 500+ WhatsApp community members
- 20+ workshop topics developed
- Consistent 2-3 workshops per week
- £5,000/month revenue
- Strong local brand recognition

12.2. Year 2: Scale & Systemize

- 1,000+ community members
- Guest expert partnerships established
- Workshop recordings and templates
- Product line expansion (10+ SKUs)
- £10,000/month revenue
- First franchise/licensing inquiry

12.3. Year 3: Platform & Legacy

- Bonu becomes THE Vietnamese F&B education platform in UK
- Online learning platform with recorded content
- Certification programs for Vietnamese cuisine
- Wholesale partnerships with restaurants
- Multiple revenue streams generating £20,000+/month
- Expand to other UK cities

12.4. Long-term Vision

The Bonu Academy:

- Comprehensive Vietnamese culinary education
- From home cook to professional chef
- From food lover to restaurant owner
- Cultural preservation through education
- Community of thousands

Physical Presence:

- Bonu teaching kitchen in London
- Retail shop for products and ingredients
- Event space for large workshops
- Vietnamese food culture center

Digital Products:

- Recipe membership site
- Video course library
- Business templates and tools
- Mobile app for community

13. Conclusion

The Bonu Playground Model represents a fundamental shift from transactional education to relationship-based community building. By removing pressure and maximizing choice, we create an environment where customers genuinely want to engage.

13.1. Core Principles to Remember

1. Trust Over Transactions
Free means free. No hidden agenda. Trust is the foundation.

2. Quality Over Quantity
Every workshop must over-deliver. The £20 trial must feel like £50+.

3. Choice Over Commitment
Let customers choose their path. They'll commit naturally when it feels right.

4. Community Over Customers
Build a community of food lovers and entrepreneurs, not just a customer list.

5. Long-term Over Short-term
£200 earned over 10 workshops is better than £200 in one package sale.

13.2. The Path Forward

The model is simple:

- Give freely (free workshops, content)
- Prove quality (£20 trial)
- Offer choice (playground workshops)
- Build community (WhatsApp, relationships)
- Scale naturally (word of mouth, organic growth)

Success comes from consistency, quality, and genuine care for the community. The money follows the value, not the other way around.

13.3. Final Thought

"The best marketing doesn't feel like marketing. The best sales don't feel like sales. The best business feels like community."

Bonu is building that community, one workshop at a time.

—

Bonu F&B Platform
Product Ecosystem & Business Model
Version 2.0 - Playground Model
March 2026